SDG 8 DECENT WORK AND ECONOMIC GROWTH PROGRESS REPORT

Sustainable Development Goal 8 (SDG 8): Decent Work and Economic Growth promotes inclusive and sustainable economic growth, productive employment, and decent work opportunities for all. It emphasizes the importance of developing relevant skills, improving access to employment, supporting entrepreneurship, and creating opportunities for individuals to participate meaningfully in economic activities. For educational institutions such as the City College of Cagayan de Oro (CCCDO), SDG 8 highlights the role of education and technical-vocational training in preparing students and community members for employment, livelihood development, and changing workforce demands. Through skills training, industry partnerships, employment assistance, scholarship programs, and entrepreneurship initiatives, the College can help strengthen workforce readiness while contributing to local economic development.

This report examines CCCDO's contributions to SDG 8 during 2024 and 2025, drawing on the 2024 institutional progress report and the supplied 2025 activity narrative and reference list. It focuses on the College's initiatives in technical and vocational education, competency development, employment access, livelihood readiness, entrepreneurship, industry engagement, and institutional quality. By comparing the two years, this report identifies areas of continuity and development in CCCDO's programs and explains how these initiatives support the broader objective of promoting decent work and sustainable economic growth. It also analyzes the available program data and accomplishments to provide a balanced assessment of the College's contributions across the two reporting periods.

In 2024, CCCDO's Technical Skills and Technology Institute (TSTI) served as the principal platform for implementing SDG 8-related initiatives. According to the institutional progress report, the College recorded 855 technical-vocational graduates, more than 400 certified trainees, over 800 jobseekers served through two employment-related events, and 122 students participating in two industry-linked learning programs. These accomplishments demonstrate the importance of technical-vocational education in equipping learners with practical competencies that may improve their employability and prepare them for specific occupational requirements. The emphasis on technical training, industry partnerships, and employment fairs also illustrates the College's approach to connecting skills development with opportunities in the labor market. Through these activities, CCCDO strengthened the relationship between education and employment while helping students and community members prepare for potential career pathways.

In 2025, CCCDO continued its technical-vocational training and scholarship initiatives while expanding its efforts to support workforce development and economic participation. The College implemented programs involving bookkeeping instruction, basic electrical skills training for women, grant-writing and business-proposal workshops, and TalenTrail 2.0 for reintegrated youth. Other initiatives included workforce-needs surveys, collaboration with the Philippine Synergia Foundation, the RISE Mindanao entrepreneurship program, and expanded scholarship collaboration with the City Education and Development Office (CEDO). The College also received institutional recognitions associated with professional development and technical-vocational quality. Collectively, these initiatives demonstrate an approach that

extends beyond preparing individuals for employment to include financial literacy, inclusive access to skills training, livelihood development, entrepreneurship, and institutional capacity-building. They also highlight the importance of partnerships and specialized programs in addressing the diverse employment and economic needs of students and members of the wider community.

The comparison of the two years provides a clearer understanding of how CCCDO's SDG 8 initiatives have developed in scope and emphasis. While the 2024 report primarily highlights technical-vocational training, certification, employment-related activities, and industry-linked learning, the 2025 initiatives encompass a wider range of programs addressing entrepreneurship, financial management, inclusive skills development, and livelihood opportunities. This progression reflects an expansion in the approaches through which the College supports workforce readiness and economic participation. Rather than focusing exclusively on preparing skilled workers, CCCDO also helps individuals develop the knowledge and practical abilities needed to manage livelihood activities, explore business opportunities, and respond to changing economic conditions.

However, the number and variety of programs alone do not establish the extent to which these initiatives have improved employment rates, income levels, job security, or long-term economic well-being. A comprehensive assessment of SDG 8 requires consistent indicators that measure not only participation in training and employment activities but also the outcomes experienced by beneficiaries. The available information does not provide a complete set of directly comparable 2025 figures for technical-vocational graduates, certified trainees, jobseekers served, or employment outcomes. Consequently, this report analyzes CCCDO's accomplishments, program coverage, institutional partnerships, and changes in program emphasis without presenting them as evidence of a quantified year-on-year increase in employment or income. This approach provides a balanced assessment of the College's contributions to SDG 8 while highlighting the importance of continued monitoring, outcome measurement, and sustained collaboration with industry and community partners

Key Findings

- Technical and vocational training was the largest category in the 2024 SDG 8 activity distribution, accounting for 6 of the 16 reported activity/output counts (37.5%), followed by industry partnerships at 5 (31.2%).
- The 2024 report recorded 855 TSTI graduates, more than 400 trainees certified, 800+ jobseekers reached through two employment events, and 122 participants in the Hotel 801 and Mabuhay industry-learning programs.
- The 2025 narrative expands the documented training portfolio to financial literacy, business proposal and grant-writing skills, technical skills for women, scholarships, and skills development for reintegrated youth.
- The employment-development emphasis also becomes broader in 2025 through RISE Mindanao entrepreneurship support, barangay-level workforce surveys and market analysis, and continuing collaboration with PSFI and CEDO.
- Professional accreditation, TESDA program-registration audit compliance, CHED recognition, and science-and-innovation collaboration appear prominently in the 2025 narrative as institutional capacity and quality milestones.
- The sources show a broadening of documented approaches, but do not supply matched 2024–2025 outcome measures to establish numerical growth in graduate employment, wages, business survival, or long-term job placement.

Institutional Context and SDG 8

SDG 8 promotes sustained, inclusive, and sustainable economic growth, productive employment, and decent work. For a local higher education institution, contributions can be made through technical and vocational education and training (TVET), competency certification, employer engagement, access to scholarships, career readiness, entrepreneurship education, skills for marginalized groups, and support for ethical and productive workplaces.

The supplied 2024 report frames CCCDO's contribution around THE Impact Ranking indicators 8.1–8.4 and connects TSTI, TESDA, DOT Region X, PESO-CDO, Pilipinas Shell Foundation Inc. (PSFI), Hotel 801, FICCO, and other partners. The 2025 narrative adds or highlights initiatives that connect skills to wider economic participation: bookkeeping, business-proposal writing, women's technical training, reintegration training, livelihood support, market-needs assessment, and RISE Mindanao.

The report distinguishes activity and output evidence—such as training sessions, graduates, certifications, job fairs, and partnership events—from longer-term outcomes such as employment rates, income growth, business survival, and job quality. Both activity types are relevant, but they represent different stages in the pathway from education to decent work.

2024 Baseline: Technical Training, Industry Linkages, and Employment Access

Technical-vocational graduation and certification

The 2024 report identifies TSTI as the core of CCCDO's SDG 8 activity. It records 855 graduates from the 10th and 11th TSTI graduation ceremonies held in June and December 2024: 419 graduates in the first half of the year and 436 in the second half. The programs included Housekeeping NC II, Electrical Installation and Maintenance (EIM) NC II, Shielded Metal Arc Welding (SMAW) NC I and II, and Barangay Health Services (BHS) NC II.

The report also records more than 400 trainees certified through industry-based training in Housekeeping, EIM, SMAW, and BHS NC II. Certification is a tangible output because it indicates that trainees completed a competency pathway recognized within the TVET system. The number of graduates and the number of certified trainees are reported as separate indicators; they should not be added together as if they represent distinct people, because the materials do not explain potential overlap between the groups.

Why it matters: technical certification can help connect learning to occupations in services, construction, maintenance, and community health. Alongside technical skills, the source emphasizes discipline, workplace ethics, and values-driven instruction. Together, these elements represent CCCDO's 2024 approach to producing workers who are trained for practical tasks and prepared for workplace expectations.

Industry-based learning and employer partnerships

CCCDO's 2024 report describes two industry-linked learning programs involving 122 students. The Hotel 801 Learning Exchange immersed 62 trainees in hotel operations, including cleaning systems, chemical safety, and quality control. The Mabuhay Training Program with DOT Region X trained 60 participants in customer-service excellence using the HEART method: Hear, Empathize, Apologize, Resolve, and Thank.

These programs added practical exposure to formal training. Learners could encounter operational standards, safety procedures, service expectations, teamwork, and communication

in contexts closer to actual employment. Partnerships with TESDA Region X, DOT-X, Hotel 801, FICCO, USAID-YouthWorks PH, and the Asian Center for TechVoc Educators helped connect competency development with standards and industry practices.

Why it matters: employers often need evidence that applicants can apply learned skills in a real working environment. Practical exposure provides a bridge between classroom instruction and workplace behavior, while partnerships create channels for aligning training with sector expectations.

Employment fairs and job-matching opportunities

The 2024 report identifies two employment-related events: the Kahanas Job Fair and the Kahigayonan Skills Education, Employment, and Livelihood Expo. It reports that the Kahanas Job Fair, organized with PESO-CDO and PSFI, connected 800 jobseekers—including CCCDO graduates—to employers and offered on-the-spot interviews and career coaching. The Kahigayonan Expo expanded job-matching and skills-showcase opportunities for out-of-school youth and new graduates.

These initiatives shifted the College's role beyond training delivery toward facilitating contact between jobseekers and potential employers. The report records people served by an employment event, not necessarily people hired; participation in a job fair is evidence of access to a recruitment channel, but does not by itself establish placement or continued employment.

Research and resource support

The 2024 report records one research publication on the influence of self-efficacy, teacher stress, and demographics on work commitment and intention to stay. The study connects workplace well-being and organizational support with workforce stability. In addition, the report identifies one major institutional support donation from PSFI consisting of training consumables and equipment for practical courses such as welding and electrical installation.

These strands complement the direct training and employment activities. Research helps frame decent work as more than access to a job: psychological well-being, organizational support, and commitment also matter. Equipment and consumables enable practical instruction and give trainees access to tools and materials associated with occupational practice.

2025 Progress: Broader Skills, Livelihood, and Institutional Pathways

Financial literacy, business skills, and workforce capacity

The 2025 narrative lists Fundamentals of Bookkeeping training sessions, including a Batch 2 reference, and grant-writing and business-proposal workshops for cluster partnership coordinators. Bookkeeping provides foundational financial knowledge relevant to managing records, handling transactions, and understanding business activity. Grant-writing and proposal development support the capacity to formulate projects and seek resources for initiatives.

Compared with the 2024 concentration on technical competencies and work-readiness programs, these 2025 examples widen the skill set described in the report. They connect vocational capability with financial literacy and project development. The latter skills can be useful not only for salaried work but also for small enterprise activity, community projects, and organizational development.

Inclusive skills development and scholarship access

The 2025 narrative highlights “Eba Ka Talaga!” Basic Electrical Skills Training for Women’s Month, delivered by CCCDO-GAD and TSTI. This is a clear example of bringing women into a technical skill area commonly associated with trades and maintenance. It gives the SDG 8 portfolio an explicit inclusion dimension by connecting technical learning opportunities with women’s participation.

The SKIL TechVoc Scholarship Program is also listed as targeting youth from communities including Puntod and Macabalan, while CCCDO and CEDO are described as strengthening collaboration to expand ISDA Scholarship opportunities. Scholarships can reduce financial barriers to skill development and expand access for learners who may otherwise have fewer routes into technical education. The supplied materials describe the scholarship initiatives, but do not provide matched recipient totals or a 2024–2025 change rate.

Reintegration, employment readiness, and community assessment

TalenTrail 2.0, reported in June 2025, is described as equipping reintegrated youth with skills for employment. The initiative broadens the SDG 8 focus to participants whose pathways into training and work may require additional support. The 2025 PSFI partnership likewise continues a youth-empowerment and employment-readiness strand seen in the 2024 institutional model.

BARANGAYAN 2025 used focus group discussion and market analysis surveys in selected barangays to identify workforce needs and opportunities. This adds a demand-side perspective to the training system: in addition to preparing learners, local workforce information can help identify what types of skills and economic opportunities are present in communities. It connects employment development with context-sensitive understanding of labor and market conditions.

Entrepreneurship and sustainable economic growth

RISE Mindanao, highlighted in November 2025, is described as supporting entrepreneurs, sustainable business growth, and innovation. This adds an enterprise-development dimension to the College’s documented SDG 8 portfolio. Whereas job fairs connect applicants to existing vacancies and TVET creates employable skills, entrepreneurship initiatives address a different route to economic participation: creating or sustaining a business and generating productive activity.

The 2025 activities can therefore be understood as a broader pathway rather than a single linear route. Some learners may progress from training to employment; others may develop skills for self-employment, reintegration, project work, or entrepreneurship. The RISE Mindanao initiative is important in this comparison because it explicitly broadens the narrative from employability toward business development and sustainable growth.

Professional recognition, quality assurance, and institutional capacity

The 2025 narrative records PRC Region X accreditation of CCCDO as a Continuing Professional Development provider, recognition from CHED Region X for student affairs and services, and compliance with the 2025 TESDA program-registration audit. It also describes benchmarking visits in Davao, participation in policy and standards consultations, and CCCDO’s entry into the DOST–NorMinCIEERD science and innovation coalition as the first local university college to join.

These milestones do not replace workforce training or job placement, but they strengthen the institutional setting in which education and skills programs are delivered. Professional-development accreditation can support structured continuing learning; TESDA audit compliance relates to program registration standards; and external recognition provides evidence that the College's wider institutional functions received formal attention. Their relevance to SDG 8 lies in the quality, credibility, and sustainability of the institution's contribution to workforce development.

The supplied narrative also lists the National Sustainability Award at CHED ICONS 2025 and additional CHED recognition. These are indicators of institutional recognition, not direct measures of graduate employment or income, but they form part of the 2025 account of organizational development and public-sector acknowledgment.

Figures and Comparative Analysis

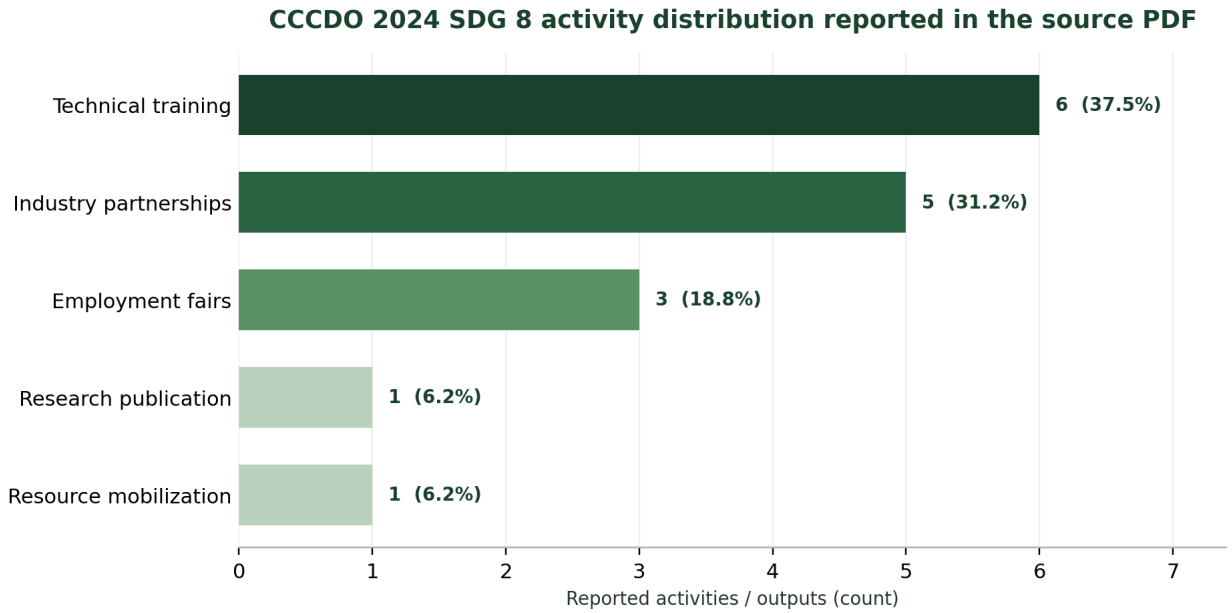


Figure 1. Programmatic distribution reproduced from the 2024 SDG 8 PDF. Percentages reflect the five categories shown in that source chart.

Interpretation: The 2024 chart places technical training at 6 reported activity/output counts (37.5%) and industry partnerships at 5 (31.2%). Employment fairs account for 3 (18.8%), while research publication and resource mobilization each account for 1 (6.2%). The pattern indicates that the 2024 portfolio emphasized building worker capability and connecting that capability with industry. Employment fairs added a job-access channel, while research and resource mobilization supported the broader training ecosystem.

The percentages total approximately 100% after rounding and summarize the distribution in the source chart; they are not shares of budget, participants, or measured economic impact.

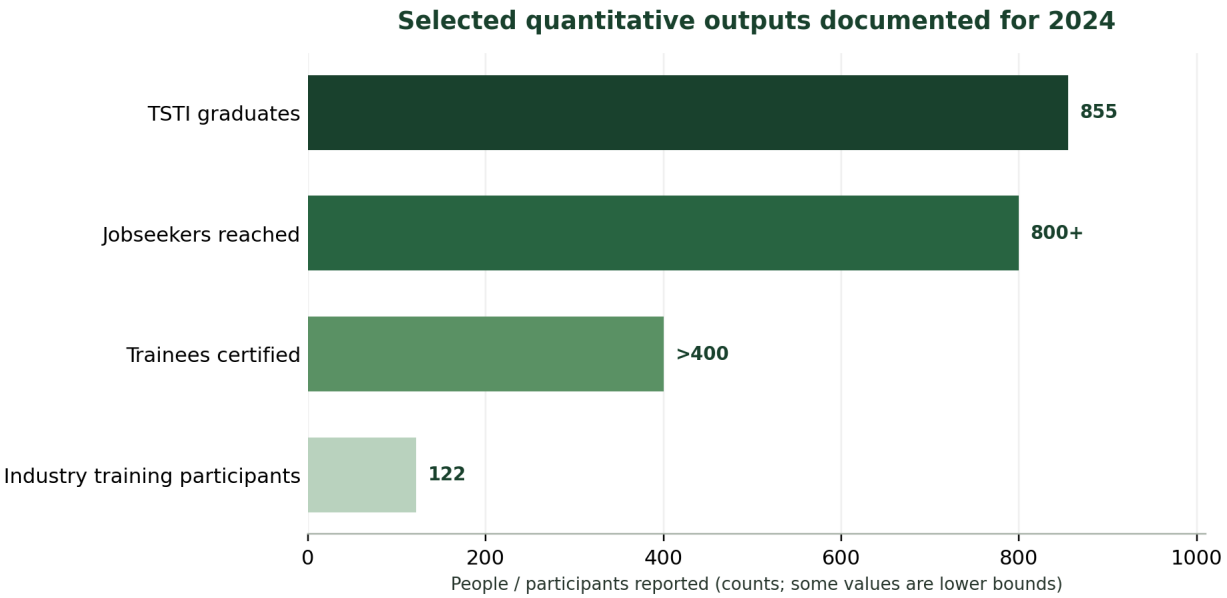


Figure 2. Selected 2024 numeric outputs in the institutional report. “>400” and “800+” are lower-bound descriptions from the source; categories may overlap and should not be added as unique beneficiaries.

Interpretation: The report states 855 graduates from the 10th and 11th TSTI graduation ceremonies, more than 400 trainees certified, 800+ jobseekers served through two employment events, and 122 trainees in two industry-linked programs. These figures reveal different dimensions of the workforce pathway: qualifications completed, certification achieved, access to employer-facing events, and practical learning exposure. They are not interchangeable measures. For example, a jobseeker who attends a fair may also be a graduate or trainee, so the chart should be read as a set of indicators rather than a combined headcount.

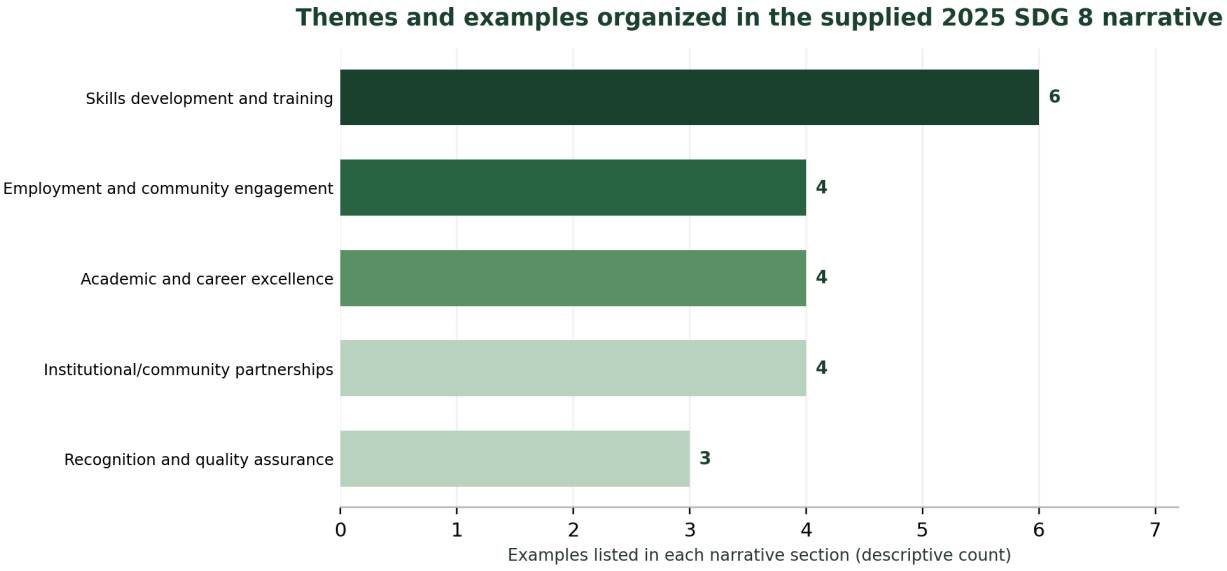


Figure 3. Descriptive count of examples under the five sections of the supplied 2025 narrative. Categories follow the narrative structure and may overlap; they are not official program totals.

Interpretation: The supplied 2025 narrative allocates the largest number of listed examples to skills development and training (6). Employment and community engagement, academic and career excellence, and institutional/community partnerships each contain 4 examples, while recognition and quality assurance contains 3. This distribution illustrates how the 2025 account broadens beyond technical instruction to include financial literacy, project development, women's technical training, reintegration, scholarship access, entrepreneurship, workforce-needs analysis, and quality-related milestones. Because the narrative headings are thematic and some activities relate to more than one theme, these counts describe the document's content rather than the full annual volume of institutional activity.

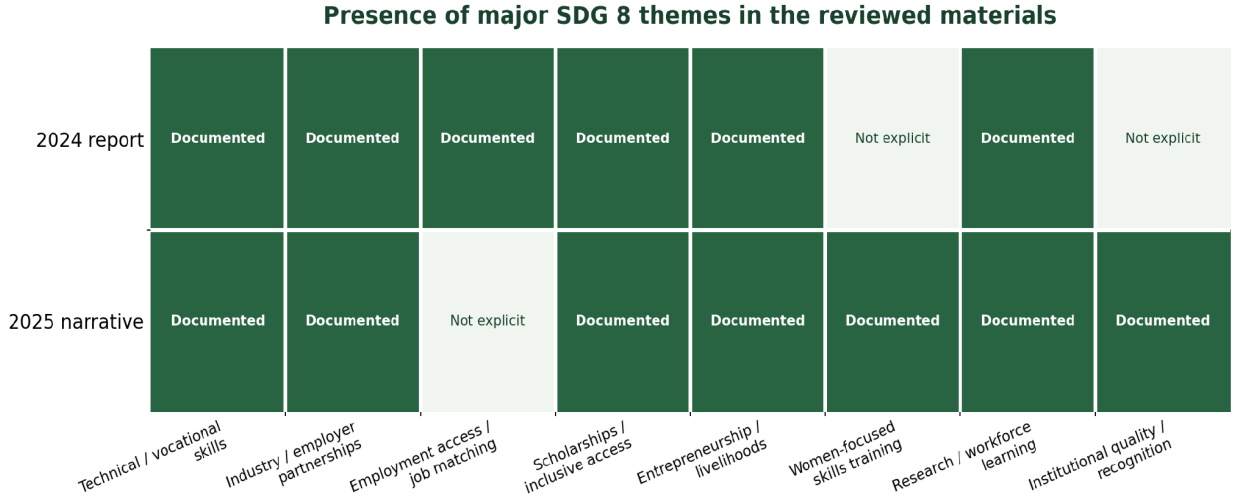


Figure 4. Presence of major SDG 8 themes in the supplied 2024 report and 2025 narrative. "Not explicit" means the particular theme is not clearly itemized in that source, not that it was absent institution-wide.

Interpretation: Technical-vocational skills and partnerships are visible in both years, demonstrating continuity. Employment access is strongly quantified in 2024 through the job fairs and jobseekers reached, while the 2025 narrative focuses more on training, scholarships, livelihoods, entrepreneurship, and institutional quality rather than reporting another comparable job-fair total. Women-focused technical training, RISE Mindanao, and the named 2025 accreditation and quality milestones are explicit in the later narrative. The comparison therefore suggests a widening of the documented approach rather than a directly quantified change in employment results.

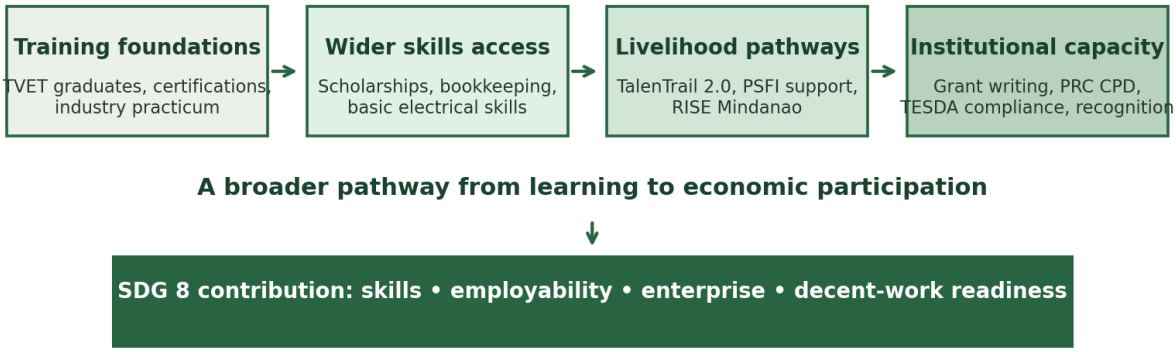


Figure 5. Conceptual pathway showing how the reported activities may connect learning, skills access, livelihood pathways, and institutional capacity to SDG 8.

Interpretation: The progression diagram links the 2024 foundations—TVET graduation, certification, industry learning, and job matching—to 2025 initiatives in wider skills access, inclusive training, reintegration, entrepreneurship, and institutional quality. In practice, these pathways can complement one another: technical skills may support employment; bookkeeping and grant writing may support business or project management; scholarships can widen access; and entrepreneurship can create opportunities beyond wage employment. The diagram explains the relationship between programs but is not a measured tracking of individual learners or proof of job placement.

Comparative Performance and Institutional Development

Dimension	2024 baseline	2025 progress described	What the comparison shows
TVET graduation and certification	855 graduates; >400 trainees certified across identified qualifications.	13th TSTI graduation reported in December 2025; continuing TechVoc scholarship and skills-development activities; 2025 graduate count not stated in the supplied narrative.	TVET remains a core route. Because the 2025 graduation count is not supplied, a direct change in graduate volume cannot be calculated.
Practical learning and partnerships	Hotel 801 Learning Exchange (62 trainees); DOT Mabuhay Training (60 trainees); 122 participants total reported.	PSFI youth partnership; CTEC best-practice exploration; expanded collaboration with CEDO; other institutional and industry engagement.	The partnership approach continues, while 2025 narratives present links to scholarships, reintegration and wider institutional capacity.
Employment access	Two events; 800+ jobseekers served, with job matching, interviews and career coaching.	Workforce-needs surveys and focus groups; RISE Mindanao entrepreneurship program; TalenTrail 2.0 employment-skills pathway.	The later narrative gives greater visibility to labor-market understanding, enterprise and livelihood development; it does not provide comparable 2025 jobseeker or job-placement totals.
Skills range and inclusion	Core emphasis on housekeeping, electrical installation, welding, and barangay health services.	Bookkeeping, basic electrical skills for women, grant writing, business proposals, TechVoc scholarships, and reintegration skills.	The documented training portfolio broadens to financial and enterprise skills, inclusive access, and support for specific participant groups.

Dimension	2024 baseline	2025 progress described	What the comparison shows
Institutional quality and recognition	One research publication and one major PSFI equipment/consumables support recorded in the 2024 summary.	PRC CPD-provider accreditation, TESDA audit compliance, CHED recognition, CHED ICONS National Sustainability Award, benchmarking, and science/innovation coalition membership.	The 2025 narrative more visibly foregrounds external validation and institutional capacity alongside program delivery.

Institutional Contribution and SDG 8 Alignment

CCCDO's reported initiatives align with SDG 8 through complementary mechanisms: competency-based training develops productive skills; certifications make acquired competencies more legible to employers; industry exposure connects instruction with real operational expectations; employment events create contact between jobseekers and employers; scholarships and women-focused training broaden access; reintegration and livelihood programs support groups whose employment pathways may require additional support; and entrepreneurship initiatives create routes to self-employment and business growth.

SDG 8-related contribution	Documented CCCDO initiatives	How the contribution matters
Skills and employment training	TSTI graduations, Housekeeping/EIM/SMAW/BHS certification, bookkeeping, basic electrical skills, TechVoc scholarships.	Builds occupational competence and connects learners to qualifications relevant to employment and livelihood.
Youth employment and work-readiness	Hotel 801 and DOT Mabuhay programs, Kahanas Job Fair, Kahigayonan Expo, TalenTrail 2.0, PSFI partnership.	Connects learning with employer expectations, workplace practice, job matching, and employment readiness.
Inclusive economic participation	Basic electrical skills training for women, scholarships for youth in communities, reintegration skills development.	Broadens opportunities for groups and learners who may face additional barriers to skills acquisition and economic participation.
Entrepreneurship and community economy	RISE Mindanao, bookkeeping instruction, grant-writing and business-proposal workshops, barangay market/workforce surveys.	Supports business knowledge, resource-seeking skills, awareness of local opportunities, and a more demand-informed view of workforce development.

SDG 8-related contribution	Documented CCCDO initiatives	How the contribution matters
Institutional capacity and quality	PRC CPD accreditation, TESDA registration audit compliance, CHED recognition, research, benchmarking, and science/innovation collaboration.	Strengthens the institutional environment, program credibility, professional learning, and capacity to sustain workforce-related education.

Institutional Impact and Economic Pathways

Taken together, the 2024 and 2025 records position CCCDO as a local higher education institution that contributes to economic participation through more than one route. The 2024 evidence is particularly strong on measurable training outputs and employment-facing events: 855 TSTI graduates, more than 400 certified trainees, 800+ jobseekers served, and 122 participants in two industry-linked programs. These outputs show the scale of the workforce-development activity reported for that year and the central role of TSTI and its partners.

The 2025 narrative expands the range of pathways described. Basic electrical skills training for women highlights more intentional inclusion in technical training. Scholarships and collaboration with CEDO foreground access to educational opportunity. TalenTrail 2.0 connects skills with reintegration and employment readiness. RISE Mindanao brings entrepreneurship and sustainable business growth into the SDG 8 account, while bookkeeping and grant-writing workshops develop financial and organizational skills that can be relevant across wage employment, business operations, and community projects.

Institutional recognitions also form part of the year-to-year story. Accreditation as a PRC CPD provider, TESDA program-registration audit compliance, CHED recognition, and participation in science and innovation networks indicate activity around institutional quality and professional standing. These are not direct measures of employment outcomes, but they show that the 2025 narrative presents workforce development within a wider institutional framework of quality assurance, professional learning, public engagement, and innovation.

The core progression is therefore qualitative and programmatic: in 2024, CCCDO's reported SDG 8 portfolio centered on technical skills, certification, employer linkages, and job-matching events; by 2025, the documented portfolio more visibly included financial and business skills, inclusive technical training, reintegration and livelihood pathways, entrepreneurship, market-needs assessment, scholarships, and institutional quality milestones. These strands matter because decent work and economic growth depend on both the capabilities of workers and the opportunities, resources, and institutions that enable those capabilities to be used productively.

Conclusion

The 2024–2025 comparison demonstrates continuity in CCCDO's commitment to linking education with work and economic participation, alongside a broadening in the themes documented in 2025. The 2024 report records substantial technical-vocational outputs, industry-linked learning, and jobseeker access events. The 2025 narrative retains the skills-development focus while extending it to bookkeeping, business-proposal development,

women's technical skills, scholarships, youth reintegration, entrepreneurship, workforce-needs analysis, and institutional quality assurance and recognition.

This evolution matters because decent work is supported by a connected system: learners need practical skills and recognized qualifications; employers and local economies need competent and adaptable workers; aspiring entrepreneurs need business and financial knowledge; and inclusive development requires access to opportunities across communities and participant groups. CCCDO's reported activities touch each of these dimensions, with TSTI and its network of public, private, and community partners serving as important connections between learning and livelihood.

The evidence supports a conclusion that the documented SDG 8 approach broadened in 2025. It does not support a quantified claim of increased employment, wage growth, or job retention, because matching 2025 outcome figures are not included in the supplied narrative. The strongest comparative finding is the widening of the reported workforce-development ecosystem while maintaining the core role of technical and vocational education.

Sources and Verification Notes

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